

Theme 15 A: Ny fitaterana

(Transport)

In the past in Madagascar, people travelled mostly on foot. Kings and nobles used the ‘filanjana’, a chair carried by men. Goods were carried by porters, or in carts pulled by zebu. Later on, the choices became very wide: rail, road, sea and river, and air. Sometimes the fare is fixed, and sometimes it is negotiable.

The taxi-brousse is very typical for linking the different towns and villages of the big island. It is inexpensive, can carry many passengers and their luggage, and can cover long distances, even on difficult roads. Some means of transport, such as the motorbike or the cart, can provide transport in remote areas that are hard to reach. Pirogues and boats are used in places beside rivers and the sea.

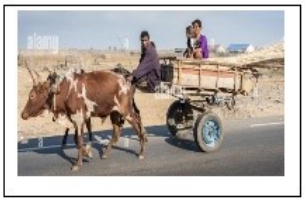
Some names of means of transport are foreign words or Malagasy-ised words, such as ‘taxi’ and ‘kamiao’. Others describe what the thing is, for example:

- **fiarandalamby** (fiara + làlana + vy): a vehicle (fiara) whose road (làlana) is made of iron (vy)
- **fiaramanidina** (fiara + manidina): a vehicle (fiara) that flies (manidina)

1. Ny fomba fitaterana eto Madagasikara (Modes of transport in Madagascar)



1.Mandeha tongotra



2. Mandeha sarety



3- Mandeha lakana



4. Mandeha bisikileta



5. Mandeha posy



6. Mandeha moto



7. Mandeha taxi-brousse



8. Mandeha Taxibe(bus)



9. Mandeha fiarandalamby(lamasinina)



10. Mandeha taxi



11. Mandeha fiara



12. Mandeha fiaramanidina



13. Mandeha sambo



14. Mandeha kamiao



15.Lanjaina

- We use the verb **MANDEHA** (to go / to take) before the means of transport or travel.

MANDEHA + means of transport / travel

Ex: Mandeha lakana (to go by pirogue)

Mandeha lakana aho. (I go by pirogue.)

- Try to make a list of the means of transport or travel shown in the pictures above, like the example.

Ex: Picture 1. tongotra (foot)

Mandeha tongotra (to go on foot)